

Module 1: Business Model Canvas
Customer Interview Capture Sheet
Team: SPARK – Courtney Fieldman / Abhishek Purohit

Five Customer Interviews:

1. Name or Title, Company:	Lucy Dinneen, Cadence Capital, Property Management Company
Date / location Interviewed:	June 3, 2025, Greenwood Village, CO
Your 2-3 key insights:	• Capital Investment Must Drive NOI: Lucy manages properties where every dollar must show a return. Efficiency upgrades are only considered if they improve net operating income (NOI) and can be justified with a 3–5 year payback. • Split Incentives Undermine Action: Most of her properties have NNN leases, which means tenants pay utility bills—removing any direct financial motivation for Lucy to fund energy improvements herself. • Asset Differentiation Matters: She’s motivated by solutions that help her lease space faster and attract quality tenants, especially in competitive or aging buildings.
Value Propositions they find important, nice to have or not important:	• Important: Anything that boosts Net Operating Income and brings down energy bills (e.g., SPARK’s energy savings + reporting). • Nice to Have: Tenant comfort tools and automation, only if they enhance property value. • Not Important: Solutions without measurable ROI or clear financial linkage.
2. Name or Title, Company:	Andrew Massik, Managing Director Silver Leaf Partners, Mortgage Broker
Date / location Interviewed:	June 3, 2025 / Greenwood Village, CO
Your 2-3 key insights:	• Split Incentive Is a Structural Market Flaw: In NNN leases, tenants pay energy bills while owners hold the asset—so neither party is naturally incentivized to fund efficiency. This keeps buildings under-optimized even when savings are obvious. • Fragmented Roles, Fragmented Decisions: Leasing agents, asset managers, and facilities teams rarely

	coordinate on energy, making portfolio-wide strategy difficult. ● Financial Structuring Is the Path Forward: He sees opportunity in lease innovations or performance-based products that directly tie energy efficiency to asset value and investment return.
Value Propositions they find important, nice to have or not important:	● Important: ○ Solutions that overcome the split incentive by aligning financial benefit with capital decision-makers. ○ Tools that unlock energy data at the portfolio level to inform asset strategies and increase property valuation. ○ Energy systems that can be structured into financial products, performance contracts, or ESG-aligned investment vehicles. ● Nice to Have: ○ Energy trading features that could generate new revenue streams or improve tenant collaboration, if bundled with visibility and assurance of savings. ● Not Important: ○ Standalone point solutions that only serve tenant-level savings without driving portfolio-level performance, ROI, or compliance.
3. Name or Title, Company:	Gene Scholl, Facility Manager, Club Greenwood
Date / location Interviewed:	June 5, 2025 / Denver, Colorado
Your 2-3 key insights:	● Real-Time Visibility Is Missing: Gene has no way to see where energy is being wasted until bills come in. By then, the opportunity is lost. ● Zone-Level Control Would Cut Waste: Large areas like fitness studios and pools often run full systems even when unoccupied—manual control doesn't scale. ● Automation Could Save Time and Money: With a small team, Gene values tools that reduce troubleshooting time and alert him before problems escalate.
Value Propositions they	● Important: Real-time monitoring, smart automation, and granular control across zones.

find important, nice to have or not important:	• Nice to Have: Built-in reporting tools to simplify communications with upper management. • Not Important: Complex solutions that require IT or engineering support to use.
4. Name or Title, Company:	Cameron Brooks
Date / location Interviewed:	June 6, 2025, Boulder, Colorado
Your 2-3 key insights:	• Highly skeptical of DER hype: Cameron believes utilities lack the structure and incentives to actually operationalize behind-the-meter intelligence at scale. • Regulatory inertia is the true blocker: Until regulators mandate market access and reward performance, utilities will not adopt platforms like SPARK. • Wants proof, not promises: Cameron would only consider IEH credible if it delivers validated, grid-level outcomes—like peak demand reduction or load shifting—in a real-world pilot.
Value Propositions they find important, nice to have or not important:	• Important: Auditable data showing grid value and cost savings in a utility-coordinated pilot. • Nice to Have: Interoperability with utility systems and tariff-aligned architecture. • Not Important: Consumer-only value props without clear utility-side impact.
5. Name or Title, Company:	Lindsay Sorhondo, Operations Director, KinderCare Learning Companies
Date / location Interviewed:	June 7, 2025 Denver, Colorado
Your 2-3 key insights:	• Comfort and Safety Are Non-Negotiable: Any energy management tool must ensure stable temperatures and air quality for young children—there's zero tolerance for risk. • Limited Staff, Limited Bandwidth: Onsite managers don't have time for manual energy control. Automation and simplicity are critical. • Budgets Are Tight: Upfront capital is limited; solutions must either show near-term savings or qualify for funding support.

Value Propositions they find important, nice to have or not important:	● Important: Automation that ensures comfort and safety without staff oversight. ● Nice to Have: Central visibility across multiple centers or corporate dashboards. ● Not Important: Feature-heavy systems that require user training or ongoing configuration.
6. Name or Title, Company:	Jared, Property Manager, Multifamily and Mixed-Use Assets, GF Properties
Date / location Interviewed:	July 16, 2025 / Denver, CO
Your 2-3 key insights:	Utility Costs Rising Fast: Jared has seen utilities rise 20–25% annually, creating a direct business pain in common areas where billbacks are restricted. Meaningful ROI Threshold: A single building could save ~\$30K annually with 30% efficiency gains—he sees this as a strong, defensible ROI for decision-makers. Control & Flexibility Matter: Some sites want automated control, others require oversight to balance comfort and tenant experience. Transparency and override options are non-negotiable.
Value Propositions they find important, nice to have or not important:	Important: Plug-and-play solutions compatible with both old and modern buildings, automation with optional manual override, and actionable reporting for owners. Important: Multi-building coordination and network effects across portfolios. Not Important: Add-ons that do not directly contribute to NOI or valuation improvement.
7. Name or Title, Company:	Drew Wallace Founder, Real Estate Data Platform
Date / location Interviewed:	July 20, 2025 / Virtual (Zoom)
Your 2-3 key insights:	Energy Is a Real Cost Center: While labor is the #1 cost in hotels, energy is a meaningful #2 (3–5% of operating costs). Rising bills make energy a material concern for operators. Simplicity Is Critical: Building operators are often overworked and not tech-savvy. Solutions must be

	simple, automated, and require minimal training. Centralized Data = Investor Value: Portfolio-level energy data creates strategic value for investors, enabling benchmarking, better asset decisions, and differentiation.
Value Propositions they find important, nice to have or not important:	Important: Centralized energy visibility across portfolios, automation that does not burden staff, and data streams that link energy to asset value. Nice to Have: Integration with existing data platforms to streamline investor reporting. Not Important: Technical or niche DER features that do not translate into financial performance or reporting value.
8. Name or Title, Company:	Tony & Ryan, CBRE Industrial Brokerage Team
Date / location Interviewed:	July 15, 2025 / Virtual (Zoom)
Your 2-3 key insights:	Tenants, Not Landlords, Pay the Bills: In triple-net leases, landlords lack direct incentive to fund energy improvements; the real customers are tenants (especially 3PLs) who face thin margins. 3PLs See Clear ROI: Tenants operating 500k–1M sq ft warehouses with high energy loads from automation, EV fleets, and forklifts would directly benefit from SPARK's savings. Landlord Angle Exists: Property managers and landlords may value SPARK if it helps attract tenants, differentiate assets, or simplify tenant setup services (similar to Prologis Essentials).
Value Propositions they find important, nice to have or not important:	Important: Tenant-centric ROI, proof of measurable energy cost reduction, and scalability for large industrial spaces. Nice to Have: Landlord-facing differentiation features that improve lease-up or tenant satisfaction. Not Important: Purely technical solutions without a clear path to either tenant savings or landlord asset differentiation.